



**Sustainability
& food waste**

Food Waste Training Agenda

1. Food Waste_The Bigger Picture
2. SA Food Loss & Waste Initiative
3. Food Waste in Our Operations
4. Waste Management SOP
5. Measuring Food Waste
6. Recording Food Waste
7. Analysing Food Waste
8. Food Waste Prevention/Reduction
9. Food Waste Diversion
10. Training_E-Learning Portal
11. Conclusion_Food Waste - Key Takeaways
12. Q&A

Food Waste_The Bigger Picture

Our Planet

Food waste is a global contributor to climate change because the resources used to grow, process, transport, and prepare food are wasted, and food sent to landfill produces methane, a powerful greenhouse gas that contributes to global warming.

Globally, food loss and waste account for approximately 8–10% of greenhouse gas emissions.

Action is being taken through the Paris Agreement, an international climate treaty signed by nearly every country which aims to limit global warming by reducing greenhouse gas emissions, and the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), which provide a global framework for sustainable development.

Our Country

South Africa is a signatory to the Paris Agreement and is committed to reducing greenhouse gas emissions as part of its national climate action plans.

Our Company

Impact Group has adopted the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) as part of its sustainability strategy, aligning our operations with global priorities such as climate action (SDG 13) and responsible consumption and production (SDG 12) – *Read about it in our Sustainability Report*



OUR PURPOSE IS: WE CARE. DOING RIGHT BY YOU

At Empact we are on a journey – a journey to do our best and be the best for our people, our clients, our partners, our community and our planet.



OUR SUSTAINABILITY ASPIRATION STATEMENT:

Along the way, we prioritise our people, partner with our clients, and uphold operational efficiency to bring about meaningful impact within our organisation and across our supply chain



SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

EMPOWER OUR PEOPLE TO PROSPER

Improve average income across our low-income earners

Create a safety culture

Enable continuous development and growth for our team



REDUCE AND MANAGE OUR WASTE

Reduce food waste from our operations

Directly and indirectly reduce other waste to landfill

Entrench responsible water usage



LEVERAGE OUR SUPPLY CHAIN FOR IMPACT

Embed systemic sustainable and ethical sourcing

Partner with local enterprises to uplift communities and strengthen local supply chains



INNOVATE FOR ENERGY EFFICIENCY

Reduce fuel usage within our operations

Directly and indirectly minimize clients' non-renewable energy consumption

Limit non-renewable energy consumption at owned sites



EMBED DIVERSITY & INCLUSIVITY IN THE WORKPLACE

Improve the holistic wellbeing of our team and their families

Create and maintain a culture of belonging

Create and maintain a diverse team representative of our country demographics.



UNDERPINNED BY ACCOUNTABILITY AND GOVERNING OVERSIGHT

Committed governance structures and impeccable reporting

Sustainability Report



SUSTAINABILITY REPORT 2025

People, partners & planet:
Bringing about meaningful **impact**

INTRODUCTIONWHO WE AREA MESSAGE FROM OUR CEOOUR APPROACH TO GOVERNANCEOUR SHAREHOLDEROUR STAKEHOLDERSOUR SUSTAINABILITY STRATEGYOUR ENVIRONMENTAL INITIATIVESOUR PEOPLE AND COMMUNITIESLEVERAGING OUR SUPPLY CHAIN FOR IMPACT

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Alignment with the 17 Sustainable Development Goals

In shaping our sustainability strategy, we gave careful consideration to aligning with the objectives of the United Nations' 17 SDGs. The SDGs represent a global call to action for governments, communities, businesses, and individuals to shift the world onto a more sustainable path – ending poverty, addressing inequality and social injustice, and tackling climate change by 2030 and beyond.

At Impact, our alignment with all 17 SDGs is not a claim of full adoption, but rather a deliberate stride toward embracing the SDGs' overarching vision of holistic inclusion. We view the SDGs as a guiding framework that informs and inspires our strategic direction. Each of our five sustainability pillars is mapped to relevant SDGs, ensuring that our efforts are both meaningful and measurable, without overstating our impact.

Through this approach, we aim to make a tangible difference in the communities where we operate, while contributing to the broader global agenda for sustainable development.

5 Pillars	SDG No.	SDG Description
Empower our people to prosper	1	No Poverty
	3	Good Health & Well-Being
	8	Decent Work & Economic Growth
	10	Reduced Inequalities
Reduce and manage our waste	6	Clean Water & Sanitation
	12	Responsible Consumption & Production
	13	Climate Action
	14	Life Below Water
Leverage our supply chain for impact	2	Zero Hunger
	8	Decent Work & Economic Growth
	12	Responsible Consumption & Production
	14	Life Below Water
	15	Life on Land
Innovate for energy efficiency	7	Affordable and Clean Energy
	12	Responsible Consumption & Production
Embed diversity and inclusivity in the workplace	3	Good Health & Well-Being
	5	Gender Equality
	10	Reduced Inequalities

Food Waste Data Reported

Improving food waste efficiency

Waste as a percentage of total meals (%)

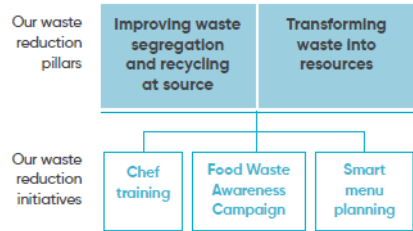


The graph shows a downward trend in food waste as a percentage of total meals served over a 12-month period. This indicates steady progress in reducing waste relative to production volumes. While fluctuations are expected due to seasonal volumes and participation rates, the overall trend reflects improved portion planning, increased awareness, and consistent implementation of waste reduction practices across sites.

These insights are invaluable as they enable us to track the impact of our waste reduction initiatives and identify patterns or anomalies that may require further attention. By working closely with our clients and regularly monitoring this data, we can make informed decisions, set achievable reduction targets, and drive continuous improvement across all sites.

Reduce and manage our waste continued

General waste and landfill diversion across our food service operations



Our waste reduction pillars:

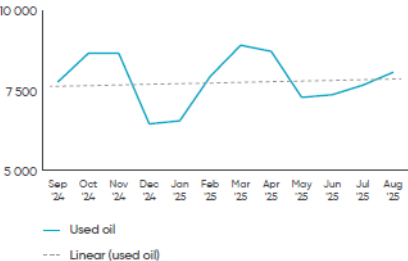
1. Improving waste segregation and recycling at source

Effective waste management starts in the kitchen and service areas. We are strengthening staff training and refining operational procedures to ensure proper waste sorting. Food waste, recyclables, and general waste are separated using clearly labelled, colour-coded bins to support correct handling and promote sustainable waste management practices.

2. Transforming waste into resources

Our used cooking oil is collected by reputable suppliers and repurposed for the production of biodiesel. This process helps reduce waste and supports the generation of a cleaner, renewable energy source. Converting used cooking oil into biodiesel is a much cleaner alternative to traditional diesel, reducing GHG emissions by up to 94%. This makes it a powerful way to lower our environmental impact and support more sustainable fuel sources.

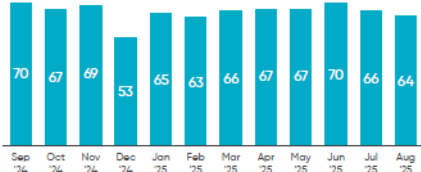
Used cooking oil (ℓ)



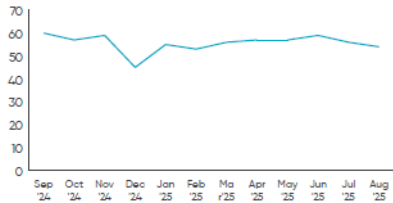
The graph illustrates that the overall trend in used cooking oil remains relatively stable. This consistent recovery supports our commitment to waste reduction.

We are committed to significantly reducing the volume of waste sent to landfill by implementing targeted waste diversion initiatives and expanding on-site composting solutions. Currently, around 40% of our sites utilise on-site composting systems such as Bokashi and biobins, while other locations partner with trusted waste management companies to ensure food waste is collected and composted off-site. Studies show that composting can reduce GHG emissions by up to 50% compared to landfill disposal. We are actively collaborating with our clients to expand these composting practices across all sites, reinforcing our commitment to building a circular food system and minimising our environmental footprint.

Waste diverted from landfill (tonnes)



Total carbon emissions avoided due to composting (tCO₂e)



The two graphs highlight the direct link between the volume of food waste composted and the reduction in carbon emissions. Over the six-month period, we consistently diverted between 25 and 45 tonnes of food waste from landfill each month through composting. This effort resulted in the avoidance of approximately 60 to 110 tonnes of carbon emissions monthly.

SA Food Loss & Waste Initiative



The South African Food Loss and Waste (SA FLW) Initiative was launched in 2020 by the Consumer Goods Council of South Africa (CGCSA), with support from the Department of Trade, Industry and Competition (DTIC) and the Department of Forestry, Fisheries and the Environment (DFFE).

The initiative is further supported by international climate action NGO WRAP, bringing together industry, government, and civil society to work towards halving food loss and waste by 2030 in line with SDG 12.3.

We joined the initiative in 2025 as the first contract catering company in South Africa, reinforcing our commitment to reducing food waste and advancing sustainability across our operations.

As active members of the South African Food Loss and Waste (SA FLW) Initiative –

- ❖ We submit our food waste data
- ❖ Develop and report on food waste action plans
- ❖ Participate in Food waste awareness campaigns
- ❖ Attend workshops
- ❖ Contribute to industry working groups focused on driving collective action to reduce food loss and waste across South Africa.

Food Waste in our operations

Food waste categories

-  Production Waste
-  Plate Scrapings
-  Unused / Expired Stock
-  Over Production Waste
-  Food Samples
-  Used Oil

Food waste by sector.

Commercial  10%	Healthcare  67%
Education  7%	Industrial  16%



50% of the food waste generated in our business is being diverted from landfill through composting solutions



Our used cooking oil is collected by approved registered suppliers and repurposed in the production of biodiesel. This process helps reduce waste and supports the generation of a cleaner, renewable energy source.



Food Waste Management SOP

We have developed a Waste Management Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) that outlines the processes and responsibilities for managing food waste within our units, ensuring a consistent approach to waste measurement, segregation, reduction, and disposal across the business.

All staff are required to familiarise themselves with the SOP and adhere to the prescribed processes to ensure a consistent and effective approach to food waste management.

FOOD WASTE

GOOD FOR OUR PLANET.
GOOD FOR OUR CANTEEN.



ENVIRONMENT

Less waste.
Lower emissions.



OUR COMMUNITY

Responsible choices.
Healthier future.



OUR BUDGET

Less waste.
Lower costs.

TYPES OF FOOD WASTE IN OUR CANTEEN

1 PRODUCTION WASTE



Food lost during preparation or cooking due to spoilage, trimming losses or errors.

EXAMPLES:

Peels, trimmings, overcooked food, accidental spoilage.

2 OVER PRODUCTION WASTE



Food prepared in excess of demand and not used before it can be served.

EXAMPLES:

Too much food cooked, extra buffet items, surplus batches.

3 USED OR EXPIRED FOOD WASTE



Food that is no longer safe or suitable to use due to expiry or poor storage.

EXAMPLES:

Expired dairy, out-of-date ingredients, spoiled produce.

4 PLATE SCRAPINGS



Edible food that is left on plates by diners and not eaten.

EXAMPLES:

Leftovers from meals, sides, bread, desserts.

5 FOOD SAMPLES



Food prepared for tasting, sampling or product checks that is not consumed.

EXAMPLES:

Menu tastings, supplier samples, quality checks.

6 USED OIL



Cooking oil and fats that have been used and are no longer suitable for cooking.

EXAMPLES:

Deep frying oil, pan oil, cooking fats.



ZEROING A SCALE

Zeroing a scale when measuring food waste is crucial for accurate and consistent measurements.



STEP 1 Plug in the scale



STEP 2 Switch the scale on



STEP 3 Put your empty container on the scale



STEP 4 Zero the scale



MEASURING FOOD WASTE

Fill the empty container with the food waste per category and record on waste tracker template.



TIP: Always zero the scale with the empty container before each measurement to ensure accuracy.



DON'T FORGET: Record the weight for each category on the waste tracker template.

FOOD WASTE MEASUREMENT & RECORDING

A CONSISTENT PROCESS. A SUSTAINABLE FUTURE.

RESOURCES AND TOOLS



Food waste collection containers



Calibrated scale to measure food waste



Designated food waste bin/s



Signage to clearly identify food waste containers and bins



Bokashi Bins / Composting bins (Where applicable)



Food Waste trackers and Workstation record form

FOOD WASTE MEASUREMENT PROCESS



SETUP

Ensure all workstations have the required and labelled waste bins.

Use dedicated clipboards and record forms for accurate daily recording.

Place containers conveniently at production areas and out of customer view.

Provide a clearly labelled large bin for food waste only. Keep the lid closed when not in use.

Ensure the scale is operational, clean, and verified for accuracy before use.



MEASUREMENT & REPORTING

Tare the empty container, then weigh and record when full.

Record waste type, unit details, and staff name on the record form.

Manager or supervisor verifies waste before disposal.

Submit daily records and update the Food Waste Tracker.

Submit tracker by the 3rd of each month; Regional reports by the 5th.

Conduct weekly/monthly analysis to identify trends and drive improvements.

File all records and reports for audit purposes.



DISPOSAL

Dispose of food waste in accordance with site-specific waste management procedures and sustainability initiatives.

This may include Bokashi bins, Bio Bins, approved composting facilities, or a designated food waste bin.

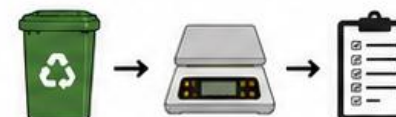


SANITISATION OF CONTAINERS

Wash and sanitise all food waste containers at the end of each production day.

Use containers strictly for food waste measurement only to prevent cross-contamination and reduce food safety risks.

Clean and sanitise food waste holding areas regularly to prevent pest activity, odours, and contamination.



Recording Food Waste

- Accurate food waste recording is essential to understanding where and why waste is occurring.
- Food waste must be recorded daily on the Food Waste Tracker in the correct category.
- Each unit must have a designated backup to record and submit the Food Waste Tracker when the Catering Manager is unavailable. Where the Food Waste Champion is not the Catering Manager, they may fulfil this role.
- Regional Managers are responsible for reviewing and verifying the accuracy and completeness of all information before the tracker is uploaded and saved on SharePoint.
- All food waste trackers must be uploaded by Work Day 5

Food Waste Tracker



Food Waste Tracker

Unit Code	
Unit Name	
Unit Manager	
Regional Manager	
Month	
Year	

Notes:

- Unit codes have 1 Alphabet and 4 numbers
- Unit Name populated automatically
- Month and Year now separated
- Functions added
- Used oil changed to one monthly total in Litres

Food Waste Categories	Total	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th	10th	11th	12th	13th	14th	15th
Production Waste (Kg's)	0															
Over Production Waste (Kg's)	0															
Unused / Expired (Kg's)	0															
Plate Scrapings (Kg's)	0															
Food Samples (Kg's)	0															

Functions																
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Select Yes if there was a function on that day

Any other notes regarding food waste this month?

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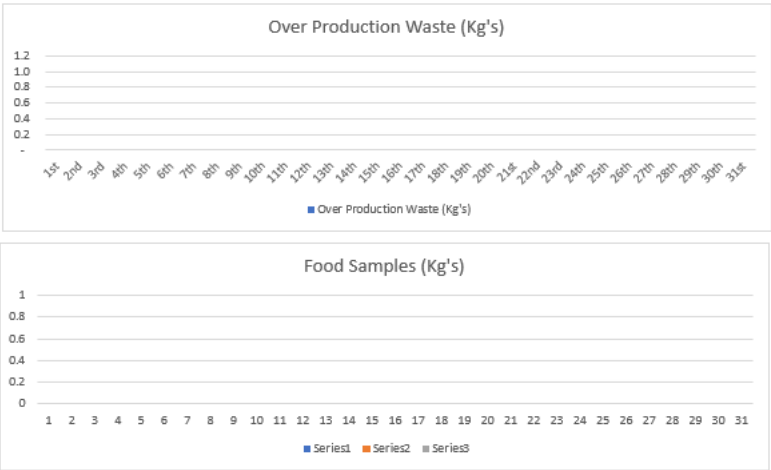
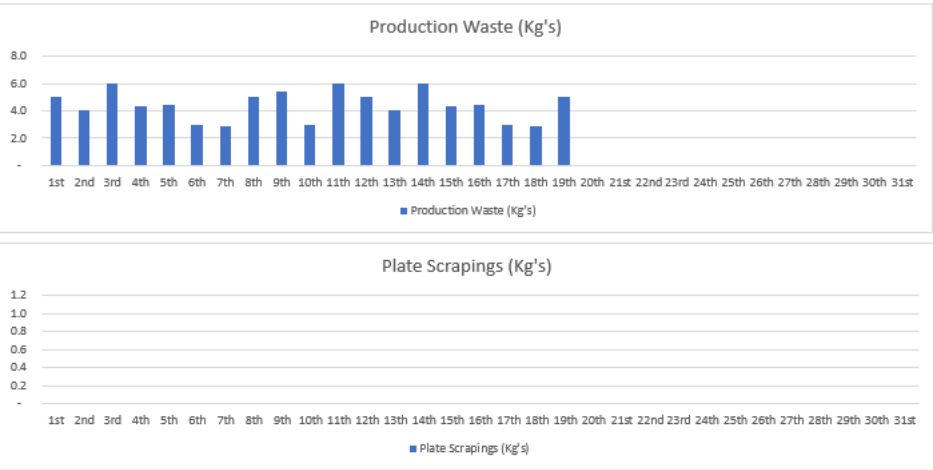
Waste Diversion	Total	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th	10th	11th	12th	13th	14th	15th
Bokashi Waste (Kg's)	0															
Bio Bins (Kg's)	0															
Other composting method (Name?)	0															

Meal Tracker	Total	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th	10th	11th	12th	13th	14th	15th
Meals produced		Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals	Total meals
Main Dish	0															
Urban Flavour Meal	0															
Chef's Signature	0															
Veggie Meal	0															
Other Meals	0															
Function Meals	0															
Function Platters	0															
Total	0															

Used oil	
Oil Collection for the month (Litres)	
Supplier name	

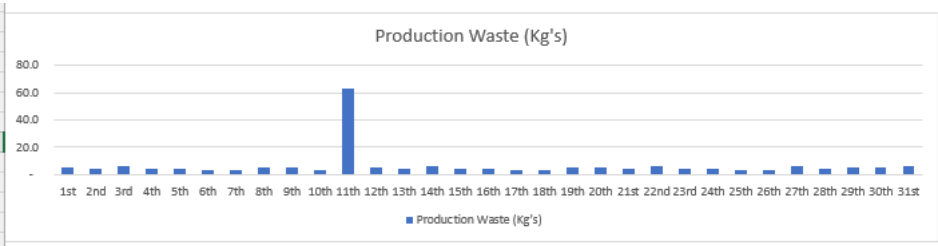
- Measure and record waste in kilograms
- Capture all food waste in the correct categories.
- Select Yes on each day there was a function
- If food waste goes into a bokashi or composting bin, complete this section
- Number of meals produced daily must be recorded here (Include functions where applicable)
- All used oil collected for the month must be recorded here

Reviewing the data



- The graphs on the tracker show the monthly trend

Food Waste Categories	Total	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th	10th	11th	12th	13th	14th	15th	16th	17th	18th	19th	20th
Production Waste (Kg's)	196.6	5.0	4.0	6.0	4.3	4.4	3.0	2.9	5.0	5.4	3.0	63.0	5.0	4.0	6.0	4.3	4.4	3.0	2.9	5.0	2.0



- Finger errors can be picked up easily

Some common issues picked up

- Incorrect document submitted – tabs are being copied onto other excel reports or tabs added
- Unit codes captured incorrectly
- Incorrect month selected or previous month not changed
- Incomplete data
- Obvious capture errors not picked up
- Daily meals not captured
- Oil not captured
- Documents submitted late

Saving the Food Waste Document

- ☐ Regional Managers must save each Food waste tracker after reviewing the data.
- ☐ Trackers must be save on Sharepoint in the correct month folder
- ☐ The file name should be **Food Waste Tracker – S0480 – May 2026**
- ☐ All trackers must be saved by **Work Day 5**

[Empact Group Intranet](#) [Empact Food](#) [Empact FM](#) [Empact Support Services](#) [Supercare](#) [Feedem](#) [Cristal](#) [Focus](#)

 **Operations**

QBR Library > Food Waste Tracking > FY27 ▾

Share

Copy link

Co

All Documents

 Name ▾	Modified ▾
 April 2026	May 2
 June 2026	June 23
 May 2026	June 1

Analysing Food Waste

The latest version of the Food waste tracker includes an RM analysis tab.

This tab should be used by Catering managers and Regional managers to get insight on the food waste data.

Production Waste – Assess whether the unit uses pre-cut fruit/vegetables or prepares from whole fresh produce?

Over Production Waste – Convert to number of meals per day by using the weight of the meal

Example: If the meal spec is 180g Protein, 100g Starch and 80g Veg,

The total meal weight is 360g = 0.36kg The total over production waste in Kg divided by the 0.36 will then give you an average number of meals.

Food Samples – Convert the total Kg of food samples to number of food samples per day by **dividing by 0.1kg**. Does it make sense for the number of meal components?

Expired Stock – Is this happening often? Why?

Reference: Excel Food Waste Tracker

Financial Impact of Food Waste

Overproduction waste has a direct financial impact on the business as it represents food that was purchased, prepared and cooked but never converted into revenue through a sale.

In simple terms – Every portion that is overproduced carries a full cost burden without any income offset.

	Meal Sold	Meal Wasted
Revenue	R40	0
Cost of Sale	R28	R30
Gross Profit	R12	-R30
GP%	30%	

Multiply this by the
**number of meals wasted
per month**

Expired Stock also carries a direct financial impact because, once stock expires, its full purchase cost becomes a write-off with no revenue recovery. This reduces Gross Profit, as the cost of goods is incurred but no corresponding sales revenue is generated to offset it.

What can you do?

Overproduction - Improve forecasting to align production with demand.

Expired Stock - Apply FIFO and tighter stock control to prevent expiry.

REDUCE FOOD WASTE IN OUR UNITS



Small changes. Big impact.

Every action we take in our daily operations can help reduce food waste, save costs and support a more sustainable future. Here's how we can make a difference in our units.



1 PLAN SMART

Forecast demand accurately using historical data, trends and upcoming events.



2 BUY RIGHT

Order the right quantities and frequency. Avoid over-ordering.



3 STORE CORRECTLY

Follow FIFO (First In, First Out). Store food at correct temperatures and in appropriate conditions.



4 PREPARE WISELY

Prepare only what is needed. Use standard portion sizes and recipes.



5 COOK TO DEMAND

Cook in smaller batches and more frequently to match demand.



6 SERVE RIGHT

Offer the right portions. Replenish gradually instead of placing large quantities at once.



7 COMMUNICATE WITH GUESTS

Encourage guests to take only what they need. Promote smaller portions where possible.



8 MANAGE STOCK CREATIVELY

Be creative with surplus stock. Repurpose excess ingredients into new menu ideas and value-adding preparations.



9 EMPOWER THE TEAM

Train and engage the team. Everyone plays a part in reducing food waste.



10 MONITOR & IMPROVE

Track food waste regularly. Review, learn and improve continuously.

REPURPOSE PRODUCTION WASTE



Waste isn't always waste.

With a little creativity, production waste can be transformed into valuable ingredients, reduce costs, and support a more sustainable kitchen.

SMART WAYS TO REPURPOSE PRODUCTION WASTE



DRY & GRIND VEGETABLE WASTE

Dry onion peels, garlic skins, leek greens, and other vegetable trimmings. Grind into powders to use as flavourful seasonings and spice blends.



WILTED HERBS INTO HERB OILS

Use wilted or surplus herbs to infuse oils. Strain and store for dressings, marinades and finishing oils.



VEGETABLE STOCKS FROM PEELINGS

Simmer vegetable peelings, ends, and trimmings to create rich, flavourful stocks for soups, sauces and risottos.



CITRUS PEELS WITH PURPOSE

Zest and dry citrus peels for flavouring, or infuse in syrups, vinegars or oils.



BREAD TO NEW CREATIONS

Repurpose stale bread into breadcrumbs, croutons, or panzanella.



SURPLUS INGREDIENTS INTO BAKED GOODS

Use excess fruit, vegetable purees, or cooked ingredients in muffins, cakes, breads or biscuits.



FRUIT SCRAPS WITH POTENTIAL

Use fruit peels, cores and trimmings to make syrups, infusions, vinegars or jams.



HERB STEMS & WOODY PARTS

Use stems and woody herbs to flavour stocks, marinades and slow-cooked dishes.



COMPOST WHAT YOU CAN'T USE

Turn unavoidable food waste into nutrient-rich compost to close the loop.



THINK DIFFERENTLY. WASTE LESS.

Look at waste as an opportunity to add value, save money and protect our planet.

Food Waste Diversion

Food waste diversion is the process of redirecting food waste away from landfill and towards more sustainable solutions.

When food waste is sent to landfill, it produces methane, a greenhouse gas that contributes to climate change. By diverting food waste, we can reduce our environmental impact and support our sustainability goals.

A method of diverting food waste from landfill is composting.

Composting of organic waste generally occurs in two main ways:

- **Aerobic Composting** – This process uses oxygen to break down food and organic waste (e.g. Bio Bins and Compost tumblers)
- **Anaerobic Composting** – This process breaks down organic waste in sealed oxygen-free conditions (e.g. Bokashi Bins)

Important!

All Site Managers and RM's need to find out what is happening to the food waste at their sites.

A tracking sheet will be sent out to confirm where food waste is being composted, all information submitted must be confirmed.





Pandae
Group of Companies



Western Cape Organic Waste Legislation

The Western Cape became the first province in South Africa to implement restrictions on organic waste being sent to landfill.

The regulations came into effect on 1 January 2022, requiring a **50% reduction in organic waste disposed to landfill by 2022**, with a target of **100% diversion of organic waste from landfill by 2027**.

This includes food waste generated by businesses, institutions, and households.

What Can We Do?

- **Prevent waste at source** through effective menu planning, forecasting, portion control, and stock management.
- **Measure and record food waste daily** to identify trends and opportunities for improvement.
- **Separate food waste correctly** to ensure it can be diverted through the appropriate waste stream.
- **Utilise food waste diversion solutions** such as bokashi systems, bio bins, composting, and approved organic waste recycling programmes.
- **Repurpose suitable food items and off-cuts** where food safety permits, such as using vegetable and meat trimmings for stocks.
- **Educate and engage staff** on food waste reduction and diversion practices.
- **Review food waste data regularly** and implement targeted actions to address key waste drivers.



Training_E-Learning Portal

Link to the Online Learning Portal: <https://lmsonline.empactgroup.co.za/>

Log in

[Lost password?](#)

Is this your first time here?

Login details are standard for all employees.

Username: Employee Number e.g. 0123456

Password: ID Number

Learning Portal Support:

Empact.LMSQueries@empactgroup.co.za

Food Waste



Enrol Key: **WASTE**

Knife Skills



Enrol Key: **KNIFE**

Seven Essentials of Exceptional Service



Enrol Key: **SEES**

Level 1: Food Handler Responsibilities



Enrol Key: **BFWS1**

Level 2: Food Hazards and Controls



Enrol Key: **BFWS2**

FOOD WASTE

— KEY TAKEAWAYS —



1

PREVENT FOOD WASTE

Plan smart, purchase wisely, store properly, and use only what we need.



2

MEASURE AND RECORD

Record all food waste daily to understand what we're generating.



3

ANALYSE AND REDUCE

Review data, identify trends, and take action to reduce food waste.



4

DIVERT FROM LANDFILL

Use composting, bokashi, or other approved systems to keep food waste out of landfill.



5

EDUCATE THOSE AROUND US

Share knowledge, encourage good habits, and inspire positive change.

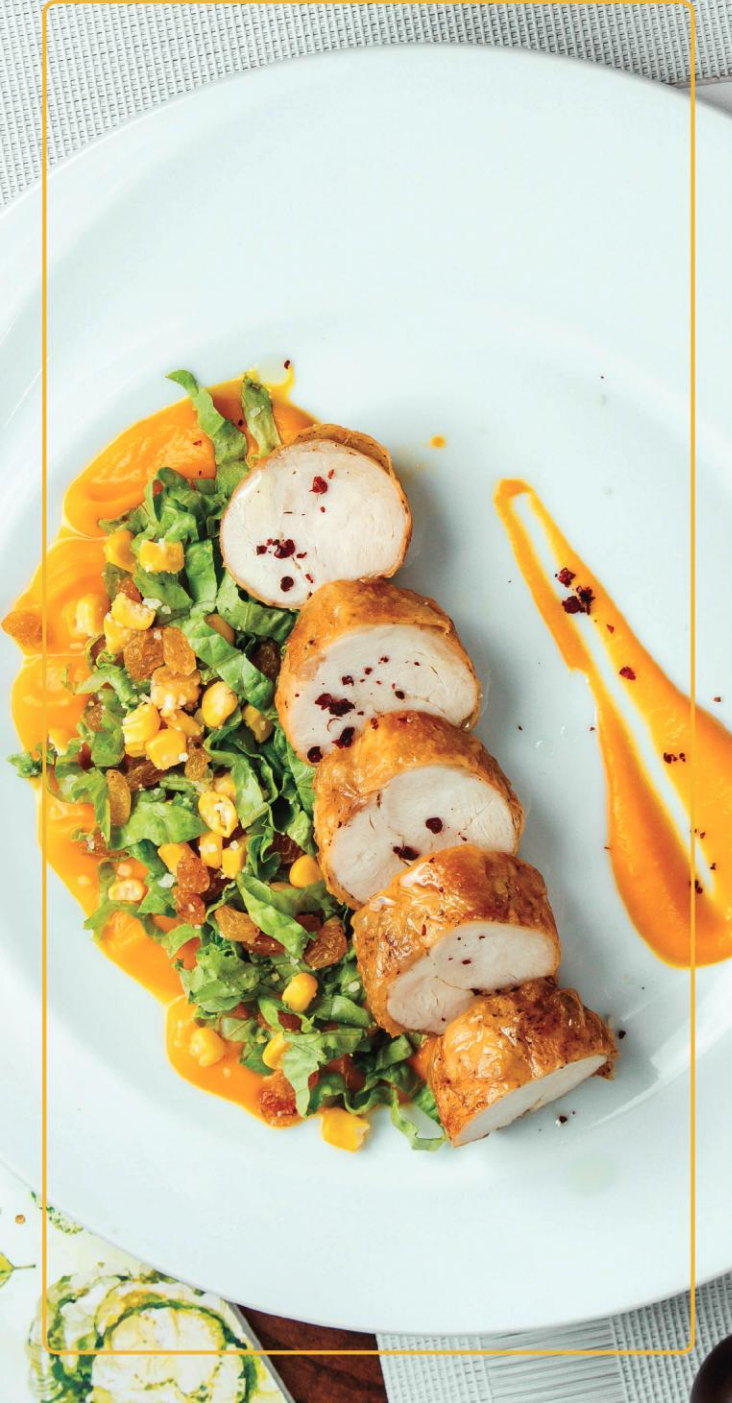


Small actions. Big impact. Better future.

TOGETHER, WE CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE.



Q&A



THANK YOU

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food
by empact group